Reading and writing

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8C, 3.7D

3.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the sequence of events, the conflict, and the resolution. In plain English: Explain the order of story events, the problem and how it is solved. 3.7D: Retell and paraphrase texts in ways that maintain meaning and logical order. In plain English: Retell or put a text into your own words while keeping its meaning and order. Today: Answer who, what and where questions about a selected event, then place it at the beginning, middle or end using a picture, AAC response or page detail.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8C, 4.7C

4.8C: Analyze plot elements, including the rising action, climax, falling action, and resolution. In plain English: Explain how a story builds to its turning point and moves toward a solution. 4.7C: Use text evidence to support an appropriate response. In plain English: Support an answer with something the text actually says or shows. Today: Explain how a character's action affects the problem or result; answer a why or how question and point to supporting page evidence.

I Do

Read a short scene from Pumpkin Soup. Think aloud: "Who is here? What happened? Is this at the beginning, middle or end?" Place one simple picture marker on the matching part of the sequence mat. Return to the real page to show the clue.

We Do

Reread the same scene together. Offer two clear picture choices for who/what/where; then place the scene in beginning, middle or end. Ask the Grade 4 learner how the character's action changes what happens next. Both learners use this same page and story.

You Do

Use a different scene from Pumpkin Soup. Grade 3 answers one who/what/where prompt and sequences the event. Grade 4 explains one character action and its effect, using a page or illustration clue. Record the exact prompt, response mode and support.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Use a familiar three-picture sequence from Pumpkin Soup: place, point to or tell what happened first, next and last. Keep a finished basket and an already-taught follow-up task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Record the question asked, the response, whether the event was placed in beginning/middle/end, the page or illustration used, and any extra prompt. This is classroom evidence; compare with an IEP goal only after the actual goal is provided.

Materials

Real books: Pumpkin Soup. Bring the props and response mats in the weekly book guide.

Book connection for this subject

Pumpkin Soup | Identify the characters' jobs, the conflict about changing roles, and the repaired plan.

Writing TEKS 3.7B

Write a response to a literary or informational text that demonstrates an understanding of a text.

Writing TEKS 4.7B

Write responses that demonstrate understanding of texts, including comparing and contrasting ideas across a variety of sources.

Writing and spelling

Respond about Pumpkin Soup: draw or select one important scene, then complete a large-print frame: "First ____. Next ____. Last ____." Offer dictation, AAC, pointing or primary writing lines.

Visual WH and story-structure routine

Use the same book for both learners. Show who, what, where, when, why and how picture cards. Ask about the beginning, middle and end. Arrange three scene cards, then let each learner answer with pointing, AAC, speech, dictation or writing. Record the response mode and prompt level.

Craft or enrichment after comprehension

Make a paper soup bowl with picture ingredients and a three-part problem/solution strip. Offer it after the comprehension response or as an early-finisher activity; keep the WH pictures and sequence strip available.

8-9 AM read-aloud

Pumpkin Soup by Helen Cooper. Return to the real pages for evidence; see the weekly book guide.

Math

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.4H, 3.4J

3.4H: Determine the number of objects in each group when a set of objects is partitioned into equal shares or a set of objects is shared equally. In plain English: Find how many objects are in each group after sharing equally. 3.4J: Determine a quotient using the relationship between multiplication and division. In plain English: Use a related multiplication fact to solve a division problem. Today: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.5A

4.5A: Represent multi-step problems involving the four operations with whole numbers using strip diagrams and equations with a letter standing for the unknown quantity. In plain English: Represent multi-step problems using the four operations, diagrams and equations with a letter for the unknown. Today: Model 3 bags of 2 pencils, then give away 2. Choose operations and show 4 left; use n for the unknown when ready.

I Do

Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings. Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings. Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings. Grade 3: Share 8 counters between 2 plates; each plate receives 4. Connect the model to 8 / 2 = 4. Grade 4: Act out 2 bags with 3 pencils each, then give away 1 pencil. Build a strip diagram; connect it to (2 x 3) - 1 = n. Find 5 pencils left. Begin with one step if needed.

We Do

Return to Pumpkin Soup and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Both students handle the shared materials. Practice one example with the teacher; then teach the two targets in separate rotations. Grade 3: after sharing 8 into 2 equal groups, use 2 x 4 = 8 to explain why 8 / 2 = 4.

You Do

Grade 3: Share 6 counters between 2 plates, then show how many are in each group. Grade 4: Model 3 bags of 2 pencils, then give away 2. Choose operations and show 4 left; use n for the unknown when ready.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Complete a mastered counting/sorting tray or known Bridges practice task at the student's established level.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Counters, plates/cups and the linked math mat. Select the matching grade-level STEMscopes lesson. Use Bridges placement to choose a separate foundational intervention. Add a visual or prop from Pumpkin Soup that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Pumpkin Soup | Use pretend soup ingredients to make equal groups or a simple input-output table for servings.

Science

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.8A

3.8A: Identify everyday examples of energy, including light, sound, thermal, and mechanical. In plain English: Recognize everyday examples of light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Today: Identify light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.8A, 4.8B, 4.8C

4.8A: Investigate and identify the transfer of energy by objects in motion, waves in water, and sound. In plain English: Investigate how moving objects, water waves and sound transfer energy. 4.8B: Identify conductors and insulators of thermal and electrical energy. In plain English: Identify materials that let heat or electricity pass through and materials that resist it. 4.8C: Demonstrate and describe how electrical energy travels in a closed path that can produce light and thermal energy. In plain English: Show that electricity travels around a closed path and can produce light and heat. Today: Observe energy transfer, test materials and build a closed circuit.

I Do

Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes. Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes. Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes. Grade 3: Show a flashlight, shaker, safely lukewarm sealed bottle and moving car. Name light, sound, thermal and mechanical energy. Grade 4: Use moving cars, sound, thermal conductors and a low-voltage battery circuit to observe transfer. Close the path to light a bulb; open it to stop.

We Do

Return to Pumpkin Soup and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Predict with objects or pictures, test together, then identify what changed. Keep one test variable different and other relevant conditions the same.

You Do

Grade 3: Match an object to its energy form; demonstrate one observable change. Grade 4: Show a transfer or closed circuit and identify what changed.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Sort familiar object/photo matches away from the experiment station. Experiments are adult supervised.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

Two puppets or figures, counters, square tiles, flashlight, shaker, battery circuit kit. Adult manages circuit parts, magnets, small items and warm materials; use a low-voltage kit only. Add a visual or prop from Pumpkin Soup that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Pumpkin Soup | Connect stirring, scooping and warming to the week's energy target and record what the action changes.

Social studies

2026-10-26 | Week 3 | Characters take action

Grade 3 | TEKS 3.9A

3.9A: Identify characteristics of good citizenship, including truthfulness, justice, equality, respect for oneself and others, responsibility in daily life, and participation in government by educating oneself about the issues, respectfully holding public officials to their word, and voting. In plain English: Recognize responsible citizenship, including honesty, fairness, respect and participation in government. Today: Name a responsible action.

Grade 4 | TEKS 4.2A

4.2A: Summarize motivations for European exploration and settlement of Texas, including economic opportunity, competition, and the desire for expansion. In plain English: Explain why Europeans explored and settled Texas, including opportunity, competition and expansion. Today: Show why Europeans explored Texas.

I Do

Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community. Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community. Use Pumpkin Soup as today's context. Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community. Grade 3: Name a responsible action. Model with one district source, naming the visible clue. Grade 4: Show why Europeans explored Texas. Use the current Texas history map, image or excerpt; name the person/event and point to the evidence.

We Do

Return to Pumpkin Soup and use its pictures, props or vocabulary as the context. Work together with a second example from the same source set. Use one large visual and one guiding question. Keep the grade-specific question visible and fade added hints.

You Do

Grade 3: Name a responsible action. Grade 4: Show why Europeans explored Texas. Use a fresh source/card; accept a model, pointing, AAC or a spoken explanation.

Rotate and switch

Teacher with Grade 3 for 8-10 minutes while Grade 4 uses the taught independent task; switch. Match supports to each learner, not the grade label. Independent task: Match two familiar source pictures or complete a known picture-to-object task.

Access and participation

Use objects or two clear choices, the learner's planned response method and wait time. Offer a private response or equivalent retry when needed; record extra help and no response separately.

Evidence and progress

Save one dated response for each grade's target above: a model/photo, selected answer, dictated sentence or work sample. Record correct / total and extra prompts separately. This is practice evidence unless today is a scheduled graded product. Use it for IEP progress only if it measures the actual goal under its required conditions; goals are awaiting upload.

Materials

District source pictures or excerpts, two-event sequence mat and writing/history frames. The classroom texts do not replace Texas history sources. Add a visual or prop from Pumpkin Soup that represents this connection.

Book connection for this subject

Pumpkin Soup | Practice taking turns, sharing jobs and repairing a disagreement in a classroom community.